

NEUROCENTS — VIDEO 11

3 Traps That Rewire Your Brain to Stay Broke — 145 beats · Video prompts

HOOK (beats 1–17)

BEAT 1

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm amber desk light

Mood: Relief — a familiar Friday ritual

Character Action: Alex reading salary notification; brain perks up

Video Motion: Hard cut in. No logo, no fade. Phone notification glows. 2s.

BEAT 2

Camera: Close-up, screen

Lighting: Flat, phone glow

Mood: Routine confirmed — baseline established

Character Action: 3,200 on screen; brain arms crossed contentedly

Video Motion: Static. Number holds; label fades in below. 2s.

BEAT 3

Camera: Close-up, screen

Lighting: Flat, dim evening light

Mood: Familiar confusion — not alarm, just pattern

Character Action: 1,980 on screen; Alex confused, not panicked

Video Motion: Cut. New timestamp. Balance lower. 2s.

BEAT 4

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Elimination — the mystery deepens

Character Action: House and bill icons with red X marks; NOT THESE label

Video Motion: Static. Icons appear; X marks draw through each. 2s.

BEAT 5

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm ambient interior

Mood: Smugness — the villain satisfied

Character Action: Brain Villain satisfied; Alex's thought bubble of small rewards

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain's expression holds; thought bubble icons glow. 2s.

BEAT 6

Camera: Medium shot, slight camera address

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Pivot — something important is about to land

Character Action: Alex turning toward camera; brain leaning forward

Video Motion: Static. Background fades to white; Alex turns. 2s.

BEAT 7

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Reframe — the premise flipped immediately

Character Action: NOT A MATH PROBLEM in bold; math equation crossed out

Video Motion: Static. Text drops in; X draws through equation. 2s.

BEAT 8

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Competence established — the problem is elsewhere

Character Action: Alex at whiteboard with correct math; brain thumbs-up

Video Motion: Static. Whiteboard content present; brain holds thumbs-up. 2s.

BEAT 9

Camera: Wide split panel

Lighting: Dual tone: blue left, amber right

Mood: The distinction made visual

Character Action: Numbers left vs feelings right; brain character on feelings side

Video Motion: Static. Split appears; brain migrates to feelings side. 3s.

BEAT 10

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Revelation building — three, not random

Character Action: Brain Villain raising three fingers, each glowing in sequence

Video Motion: Static. Fingers raise one by one; each glows briefly. 3s.

BEAT 11

Camera: Wide shot, sepia

Lighting: Soft sepia tones

Mood: Origin — the programs predate awareness

Character Action: Young Alex silhouette; three program icons forming above

Video Motion: Static. Sepia scene holds; program icons appear. 2s.

BEAT 12

Camera: Wide timeline shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Scale — evolutionary, not personal

Character Action: Evolution timeline; three trap icons persisting through history

Video Motion: Static. Timeline populates left to right; traps appear early. 3s.

BEAT 13

Camera: Close-up, phone + brain

Lighting: Flat, phone glow

Mood: Automaticity — no choice involved

Character Action: Salary notification fires; three brain traps light up simultaneously

Video Motion: Static. All three icons illuminate at the moment of notification. 2s.

BEAT 14

Camera: Wide shot, void background

Lighting: Dark gray, muted

Mood: The outcome — quiet, inevitable

Character Action: Alex holding empty wallet; Brain Villain casual beside him

Video Motion: Static. Empty wallet prominent; Brain Villain relaxed. 2s.

BEAT 15

Camera: Medium shot, direct address

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Declaration — the structure announced

Character Action: Alex to camera; Brain Villain holding labeled fingers behind

Video Motion: Static. Numbered fingers present. 2s.

BEAT 16

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, dimmed Trap 3

Mood: Curiosity gap — Trap 3 sealed

Character Action: Three trap icons; Trap 3 locked with padlock and question marks

Video Motion: Static. Trap 3 lock is prominent; question marks hover. 2s.

BEAT 17

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Open loop sealed — viewer must see Trap 3

Character Action: Bold statement; looping spend arrow; Brain Villain nodding

Video Motion: Static. Statement drops in; loop arrow animates once. 3s.

TRAP 1 — THE REWARD TRAP (beats 18–49)

BEAT 18

Camera: Title card

Lighting: Red background, white text

Mood: Marker — section declared

Character Action: Title card: TRAP 1 — THE REWARD TRAP

Video Motion: Cut in hard. Title holds 1.5s. Cut to scene.

BEAT 19

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm amber desk light

Mood: The viewer knows what Alex doesn't

Character Action: Alex at Friday desk; corner label he doesn't see

Video Motion: Static. Label appears in corner; Alex looks elsewhere. 2s.

BEAT 20

Camera: Close-up

Lighting: Warm interior light

Mood: Unawareness as the condition for the trap

Character Action: Alex's unaware face; Brain Villain nodding behind

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain nod is slow and deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 21

Camera: Wide shot, exterior

Lighting: Late afternoon warm light

Mood: The legitimate case for reward — built honestly

Character Action: Alex leaving office Friday; tired posture; week-ending body language

Video Motion: Static. Warm light on Alex; body language clear. 2s.

BEAT 22

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm interior, end-of-day light

Mood: Legitimacy — the exhaustion is real

Character Action: Alex with back pain; completed week calendar; earned exhaustion

Video Motion: Static. Calendar tasks prominent; Alex's posture communicates cost. 2s.

BEAT 23

Camera: Close-up, phone

Lighting: Phone glow, warm green

Mood: The trigger — clean and immediate

Character Action: Phone salary notification glowing green

Video Motion: Static. Notification text prominent. 2s.

BEAT 24

Camera: Close-up, skull interior

Lighting: Warm interior, brain glow

Mood: The computation begins — before Alex knows it

Character Action: Brain snapping to attention inside skull; focused calculation

Video Motion: Static. Brain posture shifts from passive to active. 2s.

BEAT 25

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red X

Mood: The absent question — it never fires

Character Action: SAVE question crossed out with red X

Video Motion: Static. X draws through the question. 2s.

BEAT 26

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, warm amber highlight

Mood: The active question — the one that runs

Character Action: DESERVE question glowing amber; no X

Video Motion: Static. Amber glow pulses once. 2s.

BEAT 27

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Reframe — blame redirected to mechanism

Character Action: Alex and Brain Villain; neuroscience icon between them; label

Video Motion: Static. Icon and label appear. 2s.

BEAT 28

Camera: Wide shot, lab

Lighting: Cool lab light

Mood: Authority arrives — specific and real

Character Action: Schultz figure in lab; brain scan lightboard; name label

Video Motion: Static. Name label fades in prominently. 2s.

BEAT 29

Camera: Close-up, centered

Lighting: Gold warm glow

Mood: Credibility anchored — the finding is real

Character Action: Nobel medal icon glowing; prize label

Video Motion: Static. Medal glows; label appears. 2s.

BEAT 30

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white, green spike

Mood: The mechanism — counterintuitive and visual

Character Action: Timeline; dopamine spike at expectation; flat line at arrival

Video Motion: Static. Spike appears at expectation point; flat at arrival. 3s.

BEAT 31

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, neutral

Mood: The sequence reversed — feeling preceded the event

Character Action: Alex with salary notification; flat post-dopamine expression

Video Motion: Static. Alex's expression: already past the peak. 2s.

BEAT 32

Camera: Close-up, thought bubble

Lighting: Warm thought-bubble glow

Mood: The spend happened mentally first

Character Action: Alex's thought bubble with glowing imagined purchases

Video Motion: Static. Thought bubble items glow warmly. 2s.

BEAT 33

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white, orange brain highlight

Mood: Timing is the mechanism

Character Action: Brain reward center glowing; BEFORE SPENDING arrow; unchanged balance

Video Motion: Static. Brain region glows; arrow and unchanged balance both visible. 3s.

BEAT 34

Camera: Close-up, receipt

Lighting: Warm restaurant light

Mood: The specific cost — not dramatic, just real

Character Action: Restaurant receipt; 85.00 line; REWARD label

Video Motion: Static. Receipt crisp; label present. 2s.

BEAT 35

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Accumulation — three becomes a pattern

Character Action: Three justified purchase items in a row; all labeled REWARD

Video Motion: Static. Items appear in sequence. 2s.

BEAT 36

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The trap's logic — internally consistent

Character Action: Three items with justification labels; Brain Villain ticking notepad

Video Motion: Static. Labels appear under each item; Brain Villain nods. 3s.

BEAT 37

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Competence of the trap — it is working as designed

Character Action: Brain Villain at desk reviewing notepad; professional satisfaction

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain reviews; expression: satisfied and precise. 2s.

BEAT 38

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The reclassification — optional became necessary

Character Action: Two columns; rewards in NECESSARY column; OPTIONAL column empty

Video Motion: Static. Reward icons in necessary column; contrast clear. 3s.

BEAT 39

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The internal logic — balanced and self-defeating

Character Action: Balance scale: effort vs rewards; perfectly balanced

Video Motion: Static. Scale sits in balance. 2s.

BEAT 40

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Escalation announced — the trap deepens

Character Action: Brain Villain turning page; smirk signaling escalation

Video Motion: Static. Page turn deliberate; smirk held. 2s.

BEAT 41

Camera: Wide shot, academic

Lighting: Warm academic light

Mood: Authority — long-term observation, not theory

Character Action: Frank figure before 30-year graph; name and institution label

Video Motion: Static. Label prominent; graph behind him. 2s.

BEAT 42

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The mechanism named — visual and clear

Character Action: Line graph rising after each reward; HEDONIC ADAPTATION label

Video Motion: Static. Graph builds left to right; baseline rises after each event. 3s.

BEAT 43

Camera: Close-up, graph

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The mechanism in detail — one reset, one rise

Character Action: Baseline rising after reward; NEW BASELINE label

Video Motion: Static. Baseline arrow moves up; label appears. 2s.

BEAT 44

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm restaurant light

Mood: Normalization — the treat has become ordinary

Character Action: Alex at restaurant; 85-euro bill; expression of normalcy, not pleasure

Video Motion: Static. Bill on table; Alex's flat expression. 2s.

BEAT 45

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm desk light

Mood: Threshold risen — what satisfied now falls short

Character Action: Alex with salary; brain unimpressed by 85-euro benchmark

Video Motion: Static. Brain expression: underwhelmed. 2s.

BEAT 46

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The ratchet visible — floor has risen

Character Action: Dinner icon at bottom labeled FLOOR; new reward levels above

Video Motion: Static. Stack structure clear; FLOOR label prominent. 2s.

BEAT 47

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The compounding cost — the trap's real damage

Character Action: Monthly bar chart growing steadily; compounding cost label

Video Motion: Static. Bars grow month by month; label appears. 3s.

BEAT 48

Camera: Close-up, skull interior

Lighting: Dim interior, tiny glow

Mood: Partial awareness — not enough

Character Action: Tiny awareness icon dimly glowing in brain corner

Video Motion: Static. Awareness icon dim but present. 2s.

BEAT 49

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: False confidence — the setup for Trap 2

Character Action: Alex confident; Trap 2 icon in background; mistaken satisfaction

Video Motion: Static. Alex's confident expression contrasts with unbeaten Trap 2 icon. 2s.

CTA (beats 50–51)

BEAT 50

Camera: Medium shot, direct address

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Direct — no pressure, just invitation

Character Action: Alex to camera; Brain Villain frozen behind him

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain freeze is deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 51

Camera: Medium shot, cut back

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Brevity — the CTA earns nothing it doesn't need

Character Action: Brain Villain rolling eyes; Alex turning back; hard cut to Trap 2

Video Motion: Brain Villain eye roll; hard cut. 3s total from CTA start.

TRAP 2 — THE SAFE MONEY ILLUSION (beats 52–80)

BEAT 52

Camera: Title card

Lighting: Red background, white text

Mood: Marker — section declared

Character Action: Title card: TRAP 2 — THE SAFE MONEY ILLUSION

Video Motion: Cut in hard. Title holds 1.5s. Cut to scene.

BEAT 53

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Warm interior light, gold label

Mood: Pride before the reveal

Character Action: Alex at laptop; RESPONSIBLE label floating above

Video Motion: Static. Label appears; Alex's expression: satisfied. 2s.

BEAT 54

Camera: Close-up, screen

Lighting: Flat, screen glow, green border

Mood: The safety net — looks responsible

Character Action: Savings account screen showing 2,000 with green border and padlock

Video Motion: Static. Screen crisp; padlock prominent. 2s.

BEAT 55

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Emotional attachment to the label

Character Action: Alex tapping padlock; Brain Villain watching with quiet interest

Video Motion: Static. Padlock tap deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 56

Camera: Close-up, screen

Lighting: Flat, screen glow, red border

Mood: Contrast — the other account revealed

Character Action: Credit card balance showing -1,800 with red border

Video Motion: Static. Red border present but less prominent than savings. 2s.

BEAT 57

Camera: Close-up

Lighting: Flat, red emphasis

Mood: The mechanism of the trap — specific and real

Character Action: 23% APR label bold on credit card; Brain Villain approving

Video Motion: Static. 23% label is large and prominent. 2s.

BEAT 58

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red counter

Mood: The cost named — unavoidable arithmetic

Character Action: Interest calculation shown; 414 euros per year label in red

Video Motion: Static. Calculation appears; counter holds. 3s.

BEAT 59

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white, pale green vs red

Mood: The asymmetry — visual and mathematical

Character Action: Savings return calculation: 32/year in pale green; contrast with 414 in red

Video Motion: Static. Both lines visible; contrast clear. 3s.

BEAT 60

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red box

Mood: The damage named — annual, compounding

Character Action: NET LOSS 382/YEAR in bold red box; Brain Villain circling it

Video Motion: Static. Red box prominent; Brain Villain's circle deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 61

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Reframe begins — not stupidity

Character Action: Alex reading finance book; competent expression

Video Motion: Static. Book and expression establish competence. 2s.

BEAT 62

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The wall is the mechanism — same money, divided

Character Action: Two equal piles separated by Brain Villain's wall; different labels

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain draws wall between identical piles. 3s.

BEAT 63

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Named — the bias gets its title

Character Action: MENTAL ACCOUNTING bold label; simple definition below

Video Motion: Static. Label and definition appear. 2s.

BEAT 64

Camera: Wide shot, academic

Lighting: Warm academic light

Mood: Authority — the highest credential in economics

Character Action: Thaler figure; Nobel and institution labels

Video Motion: Static. Labels prominent and accurate. 2s.

BEAT 65

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red X on equals

Mood: The finding stated — clean and confrontational

Character Action: MONEY = MONEY equation with X through equals; finding declared

Video Motion: Static. X draws through equation. 2s.

BEAT 66

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The structure of mental accounting made visible

Character Action: Money sorted into labeled category boxes; each treated differently

Video Motion: Static. Category boxes appear; money sorted into each. 3s.

BEAT 67

Camera: Close-up

Lighting: Warm green glow

Mood: The label creates the feeling — safety

Character Action: Green EMERGENCY box; 2,000 inside; warm glow and padlock

Video Motion: Static. Green glow warm and protective. 2s.

BEAT 68

Camera: Close-up

Lighting: Cool red light

Mood: Same amount, opposite feeling — the trap

Character Action: Red DEBT PAYMENT box; 2,000 inside; cold light, no padlock

Video Motion: Static. Cold light contrasts with previous warmth. 2s.

BEAT 69

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The contradiction stated — brain vs math

Character Action: Green and red boxes side by side with equals sign between them

Video Motion: Static. Equals sign prominent between boxes. 2s.

BEAT 70

Camera: Wide shot, space metaphor

Lighting: Dark space background, two planet tones

Mood: The felt distance — enormous despite math

Character Action: Green and red planets; equals sign floating between; vast separation

Video Motion: Static. Planets separated; equals sign still visible between them. 3s.

BEAT 71

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The villain's preference — because it's disguised

Character Action: Brain Villain approving of EMERGENCY box; genuine appreciation

Video Motion: Static. Appreciation expression genuine, not ironic. 2s.

BEAT 72

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The trap's camouflage — genuine virtue hiding the cost

Character Action: Alex with proud padlock expression; genuine discipline on display

Video Motion: Static. Expression real; trap still running. 2s.

BEAT 73

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Cost and pride in the same frame — the juxtaposition is the point

Character Action: Alex's proud expression; NET LOSS box visible beneath; Brain Villain watching

Video Motion: Static. Both elements in frame simultaneously. 3s.

BEAT 74

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm, gold accents

Mood: The disguise — virtue as camouflage

Character Action: Trap with velvet rope and RESPONSIBLE BEHAVIOR gold plaque

Video Motion: Static. Disguise complete; trap unrecognizable. 2s.

BEAT 75

Camera: Close-up

Lighting: Warm gold glow

Mood: Virtue halo — the final layer of disguise

Character Action: Brain Villain placing golden halo over savings trap

Video Motion: Static. Halo glows; Brain Villain's placement deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 76

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Name drop — seed planted for next video

Character Action: Tax refund notification; Brain Villain lighting up; same trap posture

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain's recognition is immediate. 2s.

BEAT 77

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The specific cost of the next trap — curiosity gap

Character Action: Salary spend rate vs tax refund spend rate; stark difference

Video Motion: Static. Bars compare clearly. 2s.

BEAT 78

Camera: Wide triptych

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Pattern stated — the trap is structural, not situational

Character Action: Triptych showing same Mental Accounting mechanism across contexts

Video Motion: Static. Middle column identical in both rows. 2s.

BEAT 79

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, shifting tone

Mood: Anticipation — even the villain respects Trap Three

Character Action: Brain Villain turning toward Trap 3; subtle shift in expression

Video Motion: Static. Expression shift is deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 80

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Architecture revealed — Trap 3 is the foundation

Character Action: Trap 1 and 2 icons sitting on Trap 3 foundation layer

Video Motion: Static. Foundation relationship clear; Trap 3 carries the others. 3s.

TRAP 3 — THE FUTURE IS FAKE (beats 81–114)

BEAT 81

Camera: Title card

Lighting: Deep red background, white text

Mood: Weight — the biggest trap gets more space

Character Action: Title card: TRAP 3 — THE FUTURE IS FAKE

Video Motion: Cut in hard. Title holds 2s. Cut to scene.

BEAT 82

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Distinction — this trap operates differently

Character Action: Trap 1 and 2 with dollar signs; Trap 3 without — different category

Video Motion: Static. Contrast in trap icon types. 2s.

BEAT 83

Camera: Close-up, diagram

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Category shift — psychology not spending

Character Action: Perception diagram; PERCEPTION PROBLEM label

Video Motion: Static. Diagram clean and clear. 2s.

BEAT 84

Camera: Wide shot, fork in road

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The choice — simple and immediate

Character Action: Road fork; Alex looking at LEFT path: 100 TODAY

Video Motion: Static. Left path option prominent. 2s.

BEAT 85

Camera: Wide shot, fork

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The irrational preference — about to be shown

Character Action: Right path: 110 IN 1 WEEK; Alex already leaning left despite math

Video Motion: Static. Both paths visible; Alex's lean is deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 86

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Universal — not an individual weakness

Character Action: Alex walking left; ALMOST EVERYONE label; empty right path

Video Motion: Static. Empty right path emphasizes universality. 2s.

BEAT 87

Camera: Wide shot, new fork

Lighting: Flat, slightly cooler — distance implied

Mood: Same math, different felt reality

Character Action: New fork; LEFT path: 100 IN 52 WEEKS; Alex looking neutrally

Video Motion: Static. Same fork structure; different time labels. 2s.

BEAT 88

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, cool neutral

Mood: The patience is available — when distant

Character Action: Right path: 110 IN 53 WEEKS; Alex considering

Video Motion: Static. Both paths visible; Alex's posture: considering. 2s.

BEAT 89

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The irrationality exposed — identical math, inverted choice

Character Action: Alex walking right; SAME TRADE / DIFFERENT PSYCHOLOGY labels

Video Motion: Static. Both labels prominent; contrast stated plainly. 3s.

BEAT 90

Camera: Wide split diagram

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The gap between math and psychology — made visual

Character Action: Math equivalence left; felt weight asymmetry right

Video Motion: Static. Split diagram holds; contrast clear. 3s.

BEAT 91

Camera: Wide shot, academic

Lighting: Warm academic light

Mood: Authority — Harvard behavioral economics

Character Action: Laibson figure; Harvard label; behavioral diagram behind

Video Motion: Static. Name and institution label prominent. 2s.

BEAT 92

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, academic warm light

Mood: Rigor — decades of verification

Character Action: Research timeline behind Laibson; decades of data points

Video Motion: Static. Timeline populated left to right. 2s.

BEAT 93

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The curve — non-linear, not rational

Character Action: Hyperbolic discount curve; steep near peak; flat long-term; label

Video Motion: Static. Curve draws left to right; steepness contrast clear. 3s.

BEAT 94

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white with fade effect at distance

Mood: Felt reality as a function of distance

Character Action: Three objects at increasing distance; reality fading with distance

Video Motion: Static. Fade gradient clear; label present. 3s.

BEAT 95

Camera: Wide shot, split panels

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The precise definition — importance vs reality

Character Action: Split: NOT LESS IMPORTANT / LESS REAL; Brain Villain in right panel

Video Motion: Static. Brain Villain's point deliberate. 2s.

BEAT 96

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Slightly cooler tones for Future Alex

Mood: Future Alex introduced — specific and real

Character Action: Future Alex character with retirement document; slight age indicators

Video Motion: Static. Future Alex distinct but recognizable as Alex. 2s.

BEAT 97

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, cooler tones

Mood: The specificity of Future Alex's burden

Character Action: Future Alex surrounded by future bills; holding them

Video Motion: Static. Bills numerous and specific. 2s.

BEAT 98

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, consequence chain

Mood: The chain — connecting present choices to future reality

Character Action: Consequence chain: present choices to Future Alex; chain visible

Video Motion: Static. Chain connects across frame. 3s.

BEAT 99

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, white, gap between characters

Mood: The estrangement — the key emotion of the trap

Character Action: Present and Future Alex facing each other across gap; stranger dynamic

Video Motion: Static. Gap between them prominent; expressions contrast. 3s.

BEAT 100

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The behavioral consequence — not cruelty, just psychology

Character Action: Bold statement; Present Alex turning away from Future Alex

Video Motion: Static. Turn deliberate; statement holds. 2s.

BEAT 101

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm present tones

Mood: The trap's internal logic — not stupidity

Character Action: Present Alex confident; internally consistent present-moment decisions

Video Motion: Static. Expression: completely reasonable. 2s.

BEAT 102

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Connection — Trap 3 enabling Trap 1

Character Action: Dinner receipt with Trap 1 icon arrow; connection visible

Video Motion: Static. Arrow connection clear. 2s.

BEAT 103

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Connection — Trap 3 enabling Trap 2

Character Action: Savings/debt boxes with Trap 2 icon arrow; same connection

Video Motion: Static. Arrow connection clear. 2s.

BEAT 104

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, neutral tones

Mood: The recurring delay — never arrives

Character Action: Calendar with empty savings columns; Alex flipping forward month by month

Video Motion: Static. Pattern of empty columns clear. 2s.

BEAT 105

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Slightly faded distance tones

Mood: The perpetual delay — almost arriving, never here

Character Action: Future Alex waving from permanent distance; never approaching

Video Motion: Static. Distance maintained; Future Alex's wave held. 3s.

BEAT 106

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, tech-referential white

Mood: Architecture stated — Trap 3 is foundational

Character Action: OS boot screen: PRESENT BIAS; two app icons loading beneath

Video Motion: Static. Boot sequence completes; app icons appear. 3s.

BEAT 107

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, tech-metaphor white

Mood: The dependency structure — OS and apps

Character Action: Present Bias OS; Reward Trap and Mental Accounting apps open on top

Video Motion: Static. Dependency structure clear; apps sit on OS layer. 3s.

BEAT 108

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, academic white

Mood: Evidence arrives — specific and datable

Character Action: Journal cover: 2024 issue; label prominent

Video Motion: Static. Journal cover clean and specific. 2s.

BEAT 109

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Scale — 14,000 is meaningful

Character Action: Grid of 14,000 participant icons; scale communicated

Video Motion: Static. Grid fills frame systematically. 2s.

BEAT 110

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The intervention — identity continuity

Character Action: Present and Future Alex overlapping; same face emerging

Video Motion: Static. Overlap deliberate; same-person recognition visible. 3s.

BEAT 111

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white, green 23% bar

Mood: The result — measurable and specific

Character Action: Comparison bars; future-self group 23% higher; label prominent

Video Motion: Static. 23% difference prominent. 3s.

BEAT 112

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Simplicity of the finding — one thing changed one outcome

Character Action: Three crossed-out interventions; ZERO ADDITIONAL INTERVENTION label

Video Motion: Static. Crossed-out items clear; label emphatic. 2s.

BEAT 113

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red X marks

Mood: What was NOT needed — the reframe

Character Action: App and advisor icons; bold red X marks; not the answer

Video Motion: Static. X marks clear. 2s.

BEAT 114

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The resolution — same person, same stake

Character Action: Present and Future Alex identical side by side; gap closed

Video Motion: Static. Identical figures; no gap. 3s.

SYSTEM CLOSE (beats 115–128)

BEAT 115

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The system assembled — three gears locking

Character Action: Three separate gear icons locking together; system forming

Video Motion: Animated. Gears float; connect; begin spinning together. 3s.

BEAT 116

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm Friday tones

Mood: Gear 1 active — the first mechanism

Character Action: REWARD TRAP gear spinning; salary notification visible

Video Motion: Static. Gear 1 spinning; notification connected. 2s.

BEAT 117

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: OS enabling Trap 1 — the dependency shown

Character Action: PRESENT BIAS gear enabling REWARD TRAP gear; permission signal

Video Motion: Static. Gear connection and permission signal visible. 2s.

BEAT 118

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Gear 2 active — maintaining the separation

Character Action: MENTAL ACCOUNTING gear spinning; savings and debt boxes separated

Video Motion: Static. Gear 2 maintains wall between boxes. 2s.

BEAT 119

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The combined effect — total damage hidden by the system

Character Action: All three gears; hidden damage counter; wall obscuring total

Video Motion: Static. Counter running; wall obscuring it. 3s.

BEAT 120

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Interdependence — the system is fragile if broken correctly

Character Action: One gear removed; other two slowing; coordination lost

Video Motion: Static. System degrading without one gear. 3s.

BEAT 121

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Scalability — the trap grows with income

Character Action: All three gears; income counter rising; constant percentage consumed

Video Motion: Static. Income rises; percentage line stays flat. 3s.

BEAT 122

Camera: Wide shot, academic

Lighting: Warm academic light

Mood: Two Nobel-level authorities — the finding is credible

Character Action: Kahneman and Deaton figures; Princeton label; 2010 study

Video Motion: Static. Both names and institution prominent. 2s.

BEAT 123

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The finding — income does not fix the system

Character Action: Income vs behavior graph; flat line above threshold

Video Motion: Static. Threshold visible; flat line above it. 3s.

BEAT 124

Camera: Close-up, graph

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The precise implication — income is not the solution

Character Action: Flat behavior line labeled UNCHANGED; system still consuming

Video Motion: Static. UNCHANGED label prominent. 2s.

BEAT 125

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The proportional trap — percentage is constant

Character Action: Pie chart growing; behavioral trap slice constant percentage

Video Motion: Static. Pie grows; trap slice proportion unchanged. 3s.

BEAT 126

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Scale independence — the traps don't care about salary

Character Action: Two Alex versions: 50K and 150K; same Brain Villain and gears beside each

Video Motion: Static. Both versions identical except salary label. 2s.

BEAT 127

Camera: Wide diagram shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Proportionality confirmed — the system self-adjusts

Character Action: Two pie charts; trap slice identical percentage in both

Video Motion: Static. Both pies; same trap slice angle. 2s.

BEAT 128

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The system reframe — income is input, system is the variable

Character Action: Income arrow entering gear system; processed; same output proportion

Video Motion: Static. System processes income; label appears. 3s.

IDENTITY CLOSE + GUIDE (beats 129–145)

BEAT 129

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Identity reframe begins — from failure to awareness

Character Action: Alex calm; gears visible behind him; awareness not blame

Video Motion: Static. Expression: calm self-recognition, not shame. 2s.

BEAT 130

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm sepia-to-present gradient

Mood: Evolutionary origin — protection, not sabotage

Character Action: Evolution timeline; traps appearing early; protection function labeled

Video Motion: Static. Timeline shows protection origin. 2s.

BEAT 131

Camera: Wide shot, ancestor context

Lighting: Warm earthy tones

Mood: Original function — the trap was adaptive

Character Action: Ancestor figure with functional reward signal after hunt

Video Motion: Static. Reward signal in correct evolutionary context. 2s.

BEAT 132

Camera: Wide shot, ancestor context

Lighting: Warm earthy tones

Mood: Adaptive context — categorization was survival

Character Action: Ancestor with safe/poison piles; categorical thinking as survival

Video Motion: Static. Categorization in survival context. 2s.

BEAT 133

Camera: Wide shot, ancestor context

Lighting: Warm earthy tones

Mood: Present bias was survival logic — not a flaw

Character Action: Ancestor handling immediate predator; future threat distant and vague

Video Motion: Static. Immediate threat prominent; future threat faded. 3s.

BEAT 134

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Reframe complete — the programs work, the context changed

Character Action: Three gears with original function labels; NOT BROKEN label

Video Motion: Static. Function labels replace trap labels. 2s.

BEAT 135

Camera: Wide split shot

Lighting: Earthy left, modern white right

Mood: The mismatch is structural — not personal

Character Action: Ancient environment left; modern world right; MISMATCH arrow

Video Motion: Static. Split environments; mismatch arrow prominent. 3s.

BEAT 136

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: Honest — awareness is not a cure

Character Action: Alex seeing gears clearly; gears still spinning; awareness not stopping them

Video Motion: Static. Gears still active; Alex's seeing them now is new. 2s.

BEAT 137

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The villain's position — named but not defeated

Character Action: Brain Villain with nameplate; shrug; still present but seen

Video Motion: Static. Shrug is not defiant — more resigned. 2s.

BEAT 138

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The shift — from unconscious to conscious

Character Action: Alex watching Brain Villain instead of being led; dynamic changed

Video Motion: Static. Posture shift clear; awareness visible. 2s.

BEAT 139

Camera: Medium shot

Lighting: Flat, warm neutral

Mood: The release — the most important reframe

Character Action: Alex with weight lifting; clarity expression; not dramatic relief

Video Motion: Static. Weight visible as it lifts; expression: quiet clarity. 3s.

BEAT 140

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm white

Mood: First condition — practical and achievable

Character Action: First staircase step labeled; more steps above; beginning visible

Video Motion: Static. First step prominent; steps above present but unlabeled. 2s.

BEAT 141

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white, red X

Mood: What the solution is NOT — important clarity

Character Action: Budget icon crossed out; clear X

Video Motion: Static. X draws through budget icon. 2s.

BEAT 142

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: The promise — one intervention, three effects

Character Action: Single key icon; three trap lock icons; ONE DECISION THREE LOCKS label

Video Motion: Static. End screen card appearing in corner. 3s.

BEAT 143

Camera: Medium shot, direct address

Lighting: Flat, white, end screen visible

Mood: Guide — explicit and named

Character Action: Alex to camera; end screen card fully visible

Video Motion: Static. End screen card prominent. 2s.

BEAT 144

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, white

Mood: Final gap — why don't most people make this decision?

Character Action: Crowd icons; most walking past the key; few stopping

Video Motion: Static. Crowd behavior visible; gap planted. 2s.

BEAT 145

Camera: Wide shot

Lighting: Flat, warm fade

Mood: Final seed — curiosity gap for next video

Character Action: Three traps; one key; Brain Villain reluctant nod; fade beginning

Video Motion: Music fades. Brain Villain nod is deliberate and final. 3s.